

Your bike quote has *money you don't owe.*

Every charge on a showroom quote, what it really is, and exactly what to say before you sign.

You commented "PDF", so here it is. In the video I went through the extra charges showrooms add on top of the bike's price. This guide works for any bike. I've used the Royal Enfield Himalayan 440 in Chennai as the example, with every line of the quote checked, the Tamil Nadu RTO maths, the insurance rules, and a worksheet for your own quote.

- 1 Only three things are must-pay.** Ex-showroom price, RTO, and insurance. Everything else is either already inside the ex-showroom price or optional.
- 2 Extra charges can add up to ₹30,000 or more.** It depends on the bike and the dealer. On the Himalayan quote here, ₹15,599 can go.
- 3 Two documents settle every argument.** An itemised quote in writing, and the official RTO receipt.

DEALER QUOTE	FAIR PRICE	YOU SAVE	CHARGES FLAGGED
₹2,94,270	₹2,78,671	₹15,599	7

The quote, *line by line*

The Himalayan 440 quote from the video (Chennai), with each line marked by what it really is.

LINE ON THE QUOTE	AMOUNT	WHAT IT REALLY IS
Ex-showroom price	₹2,29,000	MUST PAY
RTO + others	₹28,980	MUST PAY only the RTO part
Insurance	₹20,691	MUST PAY but you choose the insurer
Logistics charges	₹3,000	ALREADY IN EX-SHOWROOM
RSA	₹999	PAYING TWICE
Incidental charges	₹2,500	REMOVE
Extended warranty	₹3,500	OPTIONAL your choice
Service charges	₹1,500	REMOVE
PDI charges	₹2,100	ALREADY IN EX-SHOWROOM
Standard fitting	₹2,000	ALREADY IN EX-SHOWROOM
Dealer total	₹2,94,270	Fair price: ₹2,78,671

Ex-showroom, RTO and insurance: BikeWale's Chennai on-road breakdown for the Himalayan 440. Other lines: the example quote used in the video.

THE ONE THING TO NOTICE

Ex-showroom + RTO + insurance = ₹2,78,671. That is the fair on-road price. Everything above it, ₹15,599 here and ₹30,000 or more on some quotes, is up to you to question.

ABOUT THE ₹30,000 AND "ILLEGAL" IN THE VIDEO

Extra charges can add up to ₹30,000 or more. The amount grows with costlier bikes, a padded "others" in the RTO line, marked-up dealer insurance and forced accessory packs. On this example quote, the six charges from the video come to ₹12,099, or ₹15,599 with the optional extended warranty. On "illegal": some RTOs, like Pune, call handling charges illegal, but the Delhi High Court (2012) did not ban them. Safer line: "this is already in the ex-showroom price, remove it."

The ex-showroom price and *the RTO*

These two are real. But knowing what's inside them is what lets you strike the rest.

1 What's already inside the ex-showroom price

INCLUDED	WHY IT MATTERS
The bike, with factory fittings	Anything the manufacturer fits as standard is already paid for
GST	18% for bikes up to 350cc, 40% above 350cc (since 22 Sep 2025). On the Himalayan 440, about ₹65,429 of the ₹2,29,000 is GST
Transport to the dealer	This is why a separate "logistics" or "handling" line makes no sense
Dealer's margin	Covers the dealer's work, including the pre-delivery inspection (PDI)

GST share worked out as ₹2,29,000 – (₹2,29,000 ÷ 1.40). Check the official ex-showroom price for your state on the brand's website.

2 RTO in Tamil Nadu, worked out

ITEM	RULE	HIMALAYAN 440
Life tax	10% of the bike's cost up to ₹1 lakh, 12% above ₹1 lakh	₹27,480
Road safety tax	One-time, new motorcycles	₹375
Registration fee	New non-transport motorcycle	₹300
Smart card RC	Extra fee for the smart-card certificate	₹200
Total from the rules	12% × ₹2,29,000 + fees	₹28,355

Tamil Nadu Motor Vehicles Taxation (Amendment) Act, 2023; Central Motor Vehicles Rules, Rule 81. The quote shows ₹28,980, which is ₹625 more. That gap can be genuine (number plate, postage) but ask for the receipt.

A SHORTCUT I USE NOW

Take your state's tax %, multiply it by the ex-showroom price, add a few hundred rupees of fees. If the dealer's RTO line is thousands above that, the "others" is where the padding is.

Insurance is must-pay, *the dealer isn't*

A new bike needs insurance before it leaves the showroom. Who you buy it from is your choice.

3 The part nobody can change: third-party cover

Since 1 September 2018, every new two-wheeler must have **5 years of third-party (TP) cover** bought upfront. The TP premium is fixed by the government and IRDAI, so it's the same at every insurer.

ENGINE SIZE	5-YEAR TP PREMIUM	WITH 18% GST
Up to 75cc	₹2,901	₹3,423
75cc to 150cc	₹3,851	₹4,544
150cc to 350cc	₹7,365	₹8,691
Above 350cc (Himalayan 440)	₹15,117	₹17,838

Rates effective 1 June 2022 for new private two-wheelers (petrol). GST added by me and rounded.

On the Himalayan quote, ₹17,838 of the ₹20,691 is fixed TP. Only about **₹2,853** is own-damage (OD) cover and add-ons. That's the part you can shop around for. On cheaper bikes with lower TP, the OD share is bigger, so the savings are bigger.

BUYING THROUGH THE DEALER

- Easy, done at delivery
- Often priced higher, with add-ons you didn't ask for
- "Cashless only if you buy ours" is a sales line, not a rule

BUYING IT YOURSELF

- IRDAI lets you choose any insurer or agent
- Get 2 or 3 online quotes with the chassis and engine number
- Dealer can't refuse delivery if your policy matches the bike

THIS TOOK ME A WHILE TO GET

Compare the own-damage part only. The TP part is the same everywhere, so a "cheaper" quote is only cheaper on OD and add-ons.

Seven charges *to question*

In the same order as the video. Amounts are from the Himalayan 440 example quote.

4 Logistics / handling charges ₹3,000

What they say: cost of bringing the bike to the showroom. **The truth:** transport to the dealer is already part of the ex-showroom price. Some RTOs have called it illegal; at the very least, you're paying for it twice.

"Logistics is already in the ex-showroom price. Please remove it."

5 Incidental charges ₹2,500

What they say: misc. paperwork or expenses. **The truth:** no part, service or document stands behind this line. It is extra margin for the showroom.

"What exactly is this for? If there's no receipt, remove it."

6 RSA (roadside assistance) ₹999

What they say: breakdown help on the road. **The truth:** many brands include free RSA with a new bike (Royal Enfield gives the first year free), and most insurers sell RSA as a cheap add-on. Check both before paying a third time.

"RSA already comes with the bike or my policy. Drop this charge."

7 Service charges ₹1,500

What they say: advance for servicing. **The truth:** you haven't had a service yet. Most brands give free services in the first year; check the service booklet. Pay for a service when you get one.

"No service charge on a brand-new bike. Remove it."

Seven charges *to question*, continued

The last three, plus the other names the same charges hide behind.

8 PDI (pre-delivery inspection) ₹2,100

What they say: checking the bike before delivery. **The truth:** PDI is the dealer's own job before handing over a bike, and it's covered in their margin inside the ex-showroom price.

"PDI is the dealer's responsibility. I won't pay for it separately."

9 RTO + others ₹28,980

PAY RTO ONLY

What they say: registration and related costs. **The truth:** the RTO part is real and fixed by your state (see page 3). "Others" is the biggest scam word on the quote. Pay the official RTO amount, plus small receipt-backed items like the number plate.

"Show me the official RTO receipt. I'll pay only what's on it."

10 Standard fitting accessories ₹2,000

What they say: fitting charges for accessories. **The truth:** if the manufacturer already fits it at the factory, it's in the ex-showroom price. Pay only for accessories you pick yourself, at the listed price.

"These come with the bike. Remove the fitting charge."

11 Same trick, different names

IF YOU SEE	ASK
Handling / documentation charges	Isn't this already in the ex-showroom or RTO amount?
Essential kit / accessories pack	Is it compulsory? Show me the itemised price list
Coating / polish / anti-rust	Optional. Say no unless you want it
Number plate charges	Is it already in the RTO line? Pay once, with a receipt

Buying your bike, *step by step*

Most of the saving happens before you reach the showroom. Do these in order.

12 Before you visit

- 1 **Note the official ex-showroom price** for your state and variant from the brand's website.
- 2 **Work out your RTO** with the shortcut on page 3, so you know the number before they tell you.
- 3 **Get 2 or 3 insurance quotes** online. Remember, only the own-damage part can differ.

13 At the showroom

- 4 **Ask for an itemised quote in writing**, from at least two dealers if you can.
- 5 **Strike every line that isn't ex-showroom, RTO or insurance**, unless you chose it.
- 6 **Ask for the RTO receipt** and pay RTO only against it.
- 7 **Inspect the bike yourself before signing delivery**: scratches, odometer reading, all lights, tool kit, chassis and engine number on the invoice.
- 8 **Pay by a traceable method** and keep the invoice, insurance policy and RTO receipt together.

IF THEY REFUSE

Ask for the refusal in writing. Escalate to the dealer's manager, then the brand's customer care. If that doesn't work, call the National Consumer Helpline on 1915 or file a complaint on the e-Daakhil consumer portal.

WHAT FINALLY SETTLED IT FOR ME

Say it calmly and keep it short: "I'll pay ex-showroom, RTO with receipt and insurance. Remove the rest." Then wait.

Check your quote *in five minutes*

Print this, or copy it into your notes. Fill the dealer's numbers, then the fair numbers.

LINE ON YOUR QUOTE	DEALER SAYS	FAIR AMOUNT	KEEP OR REMOVE
Ex-showroom price			Keep (match brand website)
RTO			Keep (match receipt)
Insurance			Keep (best quote)
Logistics / handling		₹0	Remove
Incidental		₹0	Remove
RSA		₹0	Remove if already covered
Service charges		₹0	Remove
PDI		₹0	Remove
Standard fitting		₹0	Remove
Extended warranty			Your choice
Accessories you picked			Your choice
Total			

THE ONE THING TO NOTICE

Fair on-road price = ex-showroom + RTO (as per receipt) + insurance + only the extras you chose.

ABOUT EXTENDED WARRANTY

It isn't a scam, it's optional. On a bike you plan to keep for many years it can be worth it. Just make sure it's your decision, not a line added for you.

The glossary, *in plain words*

The words on a bike quote, explained the way I'd explain them to a friend.

Ex-showroom

PRICE AT THE DEALER

The bike's price including GST, transport to the dealer and the dealer's margin.

"Showroom la nikkura vilai."

On-road price

WHAT YOU FINALLY PAY

Ex-showroom + RTO + insurance. Anything more needs a reason.

"Road la oda vida aagura motha selavu."

RTO

REGIONAL TRANSPORT OFFICE

Where your bike is registered. The RTO line covers tax and registration fees.

"Vandi ku govt la register panradhu."

Life tax

ONE-TIME ROAD TAX

Paid once at registration. In Tamil Nadu, 12% for bikes above ₹1 lakh.

"Oru dharavai kattura road tax."

Smart card RC

REGISTRATION CERTIFICATE

Your bike's registration in a card format. ₹200 on top of the registration fee.

"Vandi oda ID card."

HSRP

HIGH SECURITY NUMBER PLATE

The tamper-proof number plate that new vehicles must carry.

"Pudhu model number plate."

Third-party cover

TP, COMPULSORY

Pays for damage you cause to others. 5 years upfront on a new bike; price fixed by the government.

"Adutha aaluku aana damage ku."

Own damage

OD COVER

Pays for damage to your own bike. This is the part you can shop around for.

"Namma vandi ku aana damage ku."

IDV

INSURED DECLARED VALUE

The value your insurer agrees your bike is worth. Higher IDV, higher OD premium.

"Insurance kanakku la vandi oda madhippu."

Zero depreciation

ADD-ON

Claims are paid without cutting for wear on parts. Useful on a new bike.

"Claim la kuraikkama full ah kidaikkum."

RSA

ROADSIDE ASSISTANCE

Help if the bike breaks down on the road. Often free with the bike or cheap with insurance.

"Vazhila nindha udhavi ku aal varuvaanga."

PDI

PRE-DELIVERY INSPECTION

The dealer's check of the bike before handing it over. Their job, already in their margin.

"Kudukkura munnadi dealer check pannanum."

Extended warranty

OPTIONAL COVER

Stretches the company warranty for extra years, for a fee. Your choice.

"Warranty ah innum konja varusham neettu."

Hypothecation

LOAN NOTE ON RC

If you take a loan, the lender's name goes on your RC until you repay.

"Loan mudiyura varai bank peru RC la."

GST

GOODS AND SERVICES TAX

Already inside the ex-showroom price. 18% up to 350cc, 40% above.

"Vilai kulla ye irukkura tax."

How the *numbers* were worked out

Every figure in this guide comes from a rule, a published price, or the example quote in the video. Here's which is which.

1. Himalayan 440 ex-showroom (₹2,29,000), RTO (₹28,980) and insurance (₹20,691): BikeWale's Chennai on-road breakdown, October 2026. Engine and specs: Royal Enfield's Himalayan 440 brochure.
2. Logistics, incidental, RSA, service, PDI, standard fitting and extended warranty amounts: the example quote used in the video. Typical amounts; your dealer's will differ.
3. Tamil Nadu life tax (10% up to ₹1 lakh, 12% above) and road safety tax (₹375): Tamil Nadu Motor Vehicles Taxation (Amendment) Act, 2023.
4. Registration fee (₹300) and smart card fee (₹200): Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, Rule 81.
5. Five-year third-party cover for new two-wheelers: mandatory from 1 September 2018 (IRDAI). TP premiums: MoRTH notification in consultation with IRDAI, effective 1 June 2022. 18% GST added by me.
6. GST on motorcycles: 18% up to 350cc, 40% above 350cc, effective 22 September 2025.
7. Free RSA for the first year on new Royal Enfield motorcycles: Royal Enfield's Ride Sure page.
8. Handling charges: Pune RTO statement reported by Rushlane; Delhi High Court, W.P.(C) 8408/2011, order dated 20 April 2012.
9. Choosing your own insurer: IRDAI rules as explained by Autocar India. Complaints: National Consumer Helpline (1915) and the e-Daakhil portal.

DISCLAIMER

This guide is for education only. It is not legal, tax or financial advice, and it does not recommend any specific bike, dealer or insurer. I am not a SEBI-registered investment adviser. Prices, tax rates and insurance premiums change, and RTO rules differ by state. The add-on amounts are from an example quote. Check the official ex-showroom price, your state transport department's rates and your insurer's policy wording before you pay.

Saved money at the showroom? *Tell me how much* in the comments.

Free to share. Made by Abinash at [@buildwithabinash](#). Send this to a friend who's booking a bike this month.